



The Yukon

One of North America's longest watercourses, meandering through some of the continent's last wild frontiers

The Yukon River is 1,980 miles (3,185 km) long, making it the third longest river in North America after the Missouri and Mississippi. Eight major rivers flow into the Yukon, and its tributaries drain an area of about 328,000 square miles (850,000 square km)—the fourth largest drainage basin in North America.

Epic journey

From its mountain source in British Columbia, the Yukon flows slowly northwest through the lowland forests of the Yukon Territory before entering Alaska, where it widens into a vast wetland area called the Yukon Flats. From here, its lower course turns southwest to wind across the entire breadth of the relatively flat central Alaska landscape to its mouth in the Bering Sea.

The vast scale of the Yukon and the remoteness of the landscapes that it crosses have led to the romantic mythology of frontier life associated with its name. Once the principal means of transportation for the pioneers of the Klondike Gold Rush at the turn of the 19th century, the river remains an epic watercourse for those with an adventurous spirit.

▷ MIGRATION ROUTE

In early May, large flocks of sandhill cranes can be seen at various points along the Yukon, migrating to nesting grounds in western Alaska and northwestern Siberia.



Despite its great length, **only four bridges** cross the Yukon River

